Imóveis Portugal

What it really costs to buy in Portugal

Taxes, mortgages and steps, with the official source for every number

United States edition · 2026 · facts checked on 24 October 2026

What you will know by the end

- Which taxes you pay on purchase in 2026 and how the transfer tax (IMT) is calculated.
- Why buyers who are not Portuguese tax residents now pay 7.5% IMT, and the exceptions.
- What a 250,000 € and a 400,000 € home cost in taxes.
- How much Banco de Portugal lets banks lend.
- The steps for buying from abroad and the yearly taxes.
- If you live in the United States: what changes for you.

This guide describes the rules; it is not advice. For your own case, talk to a professional.

Partner of this guide

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If you live in the United States

- Tax representative: the United States is outside the EU and the EEA. After the purchase you have 15 days to appoint a tax representative in Portugal or sign up for the tax authority's electronic notifications.
- IMT: if you are not a Portuguese tax resident, you pay the flat 7.5%. If you become a Portuguese tax resident within two years of the purchase, you pay 7.5% first and claim back the difference within six months.
- FBAR: US persons file an FBAR with FinCEN, separately from the tax return, when the combined value of their foreign accounts goes over $10,000 at any time in the year.
- Form 8938: for taxpayers living outside the US, it applies with foreign assets over $200,000 at year end or $300,000 at any time (single; $400,000 and $600,000 joint). The thresholds for people living in the US differ and are not covered here.
- Selling: under the Portugal–US tax treaty, Portugal may tax gains on property in Portugal, and the US keeps the right to tax its citizens. The foreign tax credit (Form 1116) avoids double taxation.

Not covered here: the filing rules of the country where you live depend on your situation. Talk to a tax adviser.

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1. IMT: the purchase tax

The property transfer tax (IMT) is paid before the deed, on the day it is assessed or within the following 30 days. The 2026 rates depend on how the home is used. The value is split in two: up to the previous bracket limit at that bracket's average rate; the rest at the marginal rate.

Owner-occupied main home (residents)

Value up to	Marginal rate	Average rate at the limit
106,346 €	0%	0%
145,470 €	2%	0.5379%
198,347 €	5%	1.7274%
330,539 €	7%	3.8361%
Up to 660,982 €	8%	–

Other home, such as a holiday home (residents)

Value up to	Marginal rate	Average rate at the limit
106,346 €	1%	1%
145,470 €	2%	1.2689%
198,347 €	5%	2.2636%
330,539 €	7%	4.1578%
Up to 633,931 €	8%	–

Above: 6% (flat) up to 1,150,853 €, 7.5% above

2. Non-residents: a flat 7.5%

Since May 2026 (Decree-Law 97/2026), buyers who are not Portuguese tax residents pay IMT at a flat 7.5% on homes, with no exemption or reduction. The rate does not apply when the buyer:

a. has been considered a Portuguese tax resident;

b. becomes a Portuguese tax resident within two years of the purchase;

c. rents the home out as a residence within six months, at a rent within the decree's caps, for at least 36 months in the first five years.

In the last two cases you pay 7.5% first and claim back the difference within six months. How the first exception applies to people who were once residents and emigrated is a question for a lawyer or tax adviser.

3. Stamp duty

- On purchase: 0.8% of the value.
- With a loan of five years or more: 0.6% of the amount borrowed.
- On the interest charged by the bank: 4%.

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4. Worked examples

Purchase taxes, rounded to the euro, using the 2026 tables. Excludes the deed, registration, legal fees, currency exchange and mortgage costs.

Home at 250,000 €

	Resident, main home	Resident, other home	Non-resident
IMT	7,042 €	8,105 €	18,750 €
Stamp duty (0.8%)	2,000 €	2,000 €	2,000 €
Total	**9,042 €**	**10,105 €**	**20,750 €**

Home at 400,000 €

	Resident, main home	Resident, other home	Non-resident
IMT	18,237 €	19,300 €	30,000 €
Stamp duty (0.8%)	3,200 €	3,200 €	3,200 €
Total	**21,437 €**	**22,500 €**	**33,200 €**

5. Mortgages: Banco de Portugal's rules

- Amount: up to 90% of the value for an owner-occupied main home; up to 80% for other purposes. The lower of price and appraisal counts.
- Payments: all loan payments together should not exceed 45% of net income (each bank may exceed this for up to 10% of its lending per year).
- Term: up to 40 years for borrowers aged up to 35; up to 35 years from that age.

Example: a 200,000 € loan pays 1,200 € in stamp duty at signing.

Rules applying since 1 August 2026.

7. Every year

- IMI: 0.3% to 0.45% of the property's tax value, at the rate set by the municipality.
- AIMI: only on total tax values above 600,000 € per person.
- Renting: residential rent earned by non-residents is taxed at 25% in Portugal, with reductions for long leases.
- Short-term rental (alojamento local): needs registration; the municipality can object within 60 days, or 90 in containment areas.

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6. The steps, from abroad

1. NIF: the tax number can be requested online through a legal representative, or in person. No tax representative is needed to get it.
2. Power of attorney: sign it at a Portuguese consulate or before a notary where you live; in that case it needs a Hague Apostille.
3. Promissory contract (CPCV): it fixes the price, date and deposit. If the buyer defaults through their own fault, they lose the deposit; if the seller does, the buyer can claim double (Civil Code, art. 442).
4. Origin of funds: banks, notaries and lawyers must obtain information on the origin of funds when the transaction calls for it (Law 83/2017).
5. Deed and registration: costs depend on the service chosen.
6. After the purchase: residents outside the EU have 15 days to appoint a tax representative or sign up for the tax authority's electronic notifications; inside the EU it is optional.

8. Checklist

- [ ] I have a NIF
- [ ] I know whether I will become a tax resident within two years
- [ ] I have quotes for the deed, registration and fees
- [ ] I asked the bank for a simulation with the appraisal
- [ ] I have proof of where the money comes from
- [ ] I had the promissory contract reviewed
- [ ] I have a power of attorney with Apostille or a consulate appointment
- [ ] I appointed a tax representative or joined electronic notifications (15 days)

9. Glossary

IMT	Tax paid when buying property.
IMI	Yearly municipal property tax.
AIMI	Additional IMI on high property values.
NIF	Portuguese tax number.
CPCV	Promissory purchase contract.
Sinal	Deposit paid on the promissory contract.
Escritura	The deed that transfers ownership.
VPT	Property tax value, the basis for IMI.

Need advice for your case?

We pass your request to a partner lawyer, bank, tax adviser or money transfer service: imoveisportugal → Talk to a partner.

Sources

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